



## **Barefoot breaks bread with Dina Robotham, owner of the Lancefield Bakery**

**Stats:** One store, 21 staff, four to six new hires each year, ages 15–40, average time with company four years

**Minimum hours per week:** ‘One shift (a shift is four to six hours, but during the week is two hours)’

**How to apply:** ‘Walk in and hand over your résumé’

Most small businesses are family businesses, where your teen is often working side by side with the owner. This is a totally different experience from working with one of the big employers. And while small businesses may not have much in the way of formal training, if your kid picks the right business and boss (like Dina) they can really feel like part of their extended family.

‘We’re a family business, and we see our staff as family,’ says Dina.

‘Being a small business owner is really tough. Yet one of the privileges is seeing young people grow, and helping build up their confidence. I know there are bad small business owners out there, but my staff make me feel proud.’

## **Can you give me an inside hack on getting a job at your small business?**

‘I don’t advertise. I have kids who come in and drop off their résumé. I want to see that they’re serious enough to write out a résumé. And so I always ring back those kids. Always.’